



Placement Experience-Verizon

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About the Company:

Verizon is a **multinational telecommunications conglomerate** and one of the world's leading providers of wireless and wireline communication services. It's a key player in the global technology and communication industry, consistently ranking high on the Fortune 500 list, currently at **#30**. They focus on delivering high-quality products and services and actively invest in AI, ML, and next-generation technologies. With its corporate headquarters in **New York City**, Verizon is recognized as the world's **second-largest telecommunications company** by revenue.

About the Role:

The role is **SDE 1 (Software Development Engineer 1)**. While the exact domain was not specified, candidates are expected to be open to work across multiple areas, including backend, frontend, AI/ML, and software development.

Overview of the Process:

The overall process consisted of

- An Online coding contest in AON Platform(Virtual)
- GD followed by AI Prompting Round-in CUIC
- Technical Interview Round– in CUIC
- HR Round-in CUIC

Recruitment Process Experience:

The placement drive was a multi-stage process that tested various skills, from technical knowledge to soft skills.

1. Online Test

The online test consisted of four sections.

- **Essay Typing:** We were given a topic and had to write an essay of 190-240 words in 25 minutes. This tested our writing and time management skills. Topic given to me was "Are Electric cars the future".

- **GenAI MCQs:** This section had 30 multiple-choice questions focused on Generative AI, including scenario-based questions. The time limit was 30 minutes.
- **Coding Round(40 Minutes):** There were two coding questions. The first was to determine if a number is "googly," which is true if the sum of its digits is a prime number. The second was a Dijkstra-based problem about finding the minimum time to collect energy while traversing cities. My understanding of graph algorithms was crucial here.
- **English/Vocabulary Assessment:** This section had a flexible number of questions and featured negative marking. A unique aspect was the '?' option, which you could select if you weren't sure of an answer to avoid negative marks. This section also included simple and enjoyable puzzles. The more correct answers you gave, the higher your level and score.

The results for the online round were announced two days after the test. Out of 322 candidates, **80 were shortlisted** for the interview round.

2. Group Discussion (GD) and AI Prompting Round

The next day, we had the GD and AI prompting rounds.

- **Group Discussion:** We were divided into teams of 9, and the discussion lasted about 25 minutes. The topic was "Are online ways of life (online education, hybrid work, e-commerce, etc.) better or not?" The key here was the **quality of your speech** and your active participation. The panel judged us on how well we involved ourselves in the discussion and contributed meaningfully, rather than just stating a couple of points and staying silent. From my panel, 7 out of 9 were selected, while other panels had a higher rejection rate.
- **AI Prompting Round:** This was a **non-eliminary** round. We had to choose a problem statement from a given list, write a prompt to solve it using an AI tool, and explain the prompting technique used. We also had to mention any previous AI/ML projects we had worked on. It's important to be fully knowledgeable about what you submit in this round, as it formed the basis for many questions in the technical interview. Having AI/ML projects on your resume definitely adds more value.

3. Technical Interview

The technical interview lasted for about an hour. After a brief self-introduction and introduction from the interviewer, he delved into my projects, showing a particular interest in my **final year project**. We had a deep, 20-minute discussion on it, and he seemed impressed.

Next, the interviewer transitioned to my responses from the **AI Prompting round**. I had chosen a problem statement related to **cyber security**, and he asked me basic questions on the topic to gauge my foundational knowledge. He also asked me to explain in detail **why I had framed the prompt the way I did** and to walk him through my entire approach. This part of the interview reinforced the importance of being completely aware of what you submit in the AI prompting round.

He then moved on to DSA, asking a basic string-based palindrome question. He also asked for a dry run of **Binary Search**, its time complexity, and how that complexity is derived. The same was asked for **Merge Sort**. The interview then shifted to **SQL**. I was asked to explain all the different types of **JOINS** with proper examples and to differentiate between a **LEFT JOIN** and an **OUTER JOIN**. He then gave me a medium-level SQL question involving two tables. I couldn't provide a complete solution, but I politely explained that I was unable to come up with one, and he was fine with it. The interview concluded with questions about my knowledge of Verizon and my motivation for wanting to join the company. I

asked two sensible, high-quality questions, which is always a good practice. Of the 80 shortlisted students, 32 were selected for the HR round.

4. HR Interview

The HR interview was straightforward and lasted about 15 minutes. He asked me to briefly explain my projects, inquired about my family background, asked the typical “Where do you see yourself in 5 years?” question, my location preference and again, asked why I wanted to join Verizon. A crucial tip here is to be flexible about location. When asked for a location preference, it's best to say you are **open to any location based on the company's requirements**, as rejections can happen due to this. All 32 students who made it to the HR round were selected, and I was one of them.

MY PREPARATION STRATEGY:

I began my preparation during my 6th-semester holidays, focusing on a strategic approach to cover essential topics. My main focus was on **Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA)**, particularly **Arrays and Strings**, as well as **Greedy algorithms** and **Dynamic Programming (DP)**. I also made sure to learn the fundamentals of **Trees and Graphs**.

I highly recommend utilizing **Striver's A to Z DSA sheet** and his video tutorials from **TakeYouForward**. This resource proved to be extremely helpful. For practice, I focused on the **LeetCode 150** and **LeetCode 75** lists, which helped me build a strong problem-solving foundation. In addition to DSA, I extensively practiced **SQL queries**, solving easy and medium-level questions, which gave me a lot of confidence in this area. I learnt all the core concepts from GeekForGeeks and InterviewBit.

One of the most important aspects of preparation is maintaining a **competitive spirit**. I found that learning and practicing with friends was far more effective than studying alone. This collaborative environment kept me motivated and helped me improve faster. It's also worth noting that while a good CGPA is advisable for eligibility, typically an **8.0 and above** is a safe bet, it's the skills you demonstrate that matter most in the end.

TIPS and TRICKS:

Focus on Fundamentals: A strong foundation in **Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA)**, particularly **Arrays and Strings**, is essential as most of the companies focus on these. Practice problems on platforms like LeetCode, Hackerrank etc.

Be a Team Player: Learning and preparing with friends fosters a **competitive and supportive environment** that makes the process more enjoyable and effective.

Be Honest: If you don't know the solution to a problem, it's better to be honest and polite rather than trying to fake it.

Ask Quality Questions: Always prepare and ask good, sensible questions to the interviewer at the end. It shows your genuine interest in the role and the company.

Master Your Communication Skills: Strong communication is crucial. Make sure you can articulate your thoughts clearly and confidently. Practice explaining your projects and problem-solving approaches to others.

Showcase Flagship Projects: Instead of listing every project you've ever worked on, focus on your **flagship projects**. These are the projects where you made a significant contribution to the real world and that provide genuine value. Be prepared to discuss these in detail, as they will be a focal point of your interviews.

Hope this detailed breakdown of my experience helps you in your preparation.

All the best!